



◀ LATE ANGLO-SAXON SWORD

Date 900–1050 CE

Origin England

Length (Surviving)
50cm (19¾in)

This pattern-welded sword's blade is mostly broken off, and its upper and lower guards curve in opposite directions. Anglo-Saxon swords were balanced around halfway down the blade, making them better adapted for cutting strokes.



▲ DECORATED ANGLO-SAXON SWORD HILT

Date Mid-8th century CE

Origin England

Material Silver, gold filigree

This ornate early Anglo-Saxon sword has an intricate gold-filigree pommel with interlaced snakes and grapes against a vine pattern. It would have belonged to a high-status warrior or noble.



◀ NORMAN SPUR

Date 11th century

Origin England

Material Iron

Knights riding on horseback played a key role in Norman armies. The riding boots of these warriors were equipped with spurs with spiked ends to help direct the horses.



► NORMAN HELMET

Date 11th century CE

Origin England or northern France

Material Iron

Norman warriors wore conical metal helmets, much like earlier medieval *Spangenhelms*. Norman helmets, however, also featured a long, thin nose guard for better facial protection.

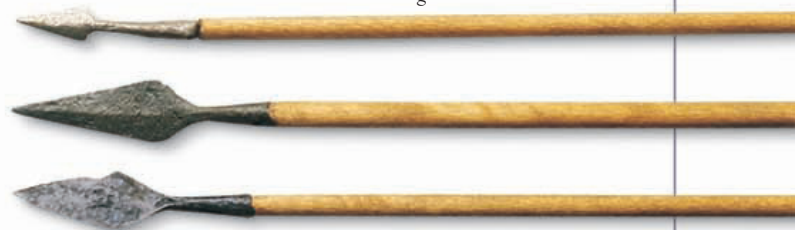


▼ NORMAN ARROWS

Date 11th–12th century CE

Origin England

The narrow, pointed heads of Norman arrows were designed to penetrate mail. Despite their effectiveness on the battlefield, however, arrows were little used by the Normans before the Battle of Hastings against the English in 1066.



◀ NORMAN SWORD

Date c.1100

Origin England

Weight 1.28kg (2¾lb)

Length 96.5cm (38in)

Norman swords generally had brazil-nut-shaped pommels, long, flat cross-guards, and a broad, flat blade that was adapted for use both from horseback and on foot.